Devan Velji

http://devanvelji.com/

EDUCATION:

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SAN DIEGO La Jolla, CA

B.S. Mathematics & Economics, Minor: Marine Sciences / Provost Honors September 2022 - March 2026

Coursework: Econometrics, Market Design, Stochastic Processes II, Numerical Analysis of PDEs, Geophysical Fluid Dynamics

UNIVERSITY COLLEGE LONDON London, UK

Study Abroad Program Summer 2023

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE:

BHOL Remote

Founder & CEO October 2025 – Present

- Built and shipped an iOS language learning app for 22 Indian languages using Swift, integrating OpenAI, ElevenLabs & Sarvam TTS/STT, and custom pronunciation evaluator hosted on a Cloudflare multi-service backend.
- Engineered agentic content development, A/B testing, and CI/CD pipelines for autonomous continuous improvement of the app based on user insights derived from Posthog Analytics and RevenueCat.
- Scaled through UGC and automated AI generated content across social media channels, as well as through viral features that induce network-effect type marketing and distribution while on a bootstrapped budget.

TEQUILA FORTALEZA Rancho Santa Fe, CA

Business Operations & Marketing Intern August 2024 – October 2025

- Automated Excel report creation for sales and marketing teams using Python and VBA, saving ~15 hours per week.
- Executed 15 quarterly retreats to Tequila, Mexico, to showcase distillery operations as focused marketing channel.
- Overhauled and automated operational workflows by introducing an inventory allocation tracking system, reducing manual errors by 85%, cutting processing time by 5+ hours per week, and enhancing management communication.

BUTTERFLYMX New York, NY

Data Analytics Intern July 2025 – September 2025

- Refactored 30+ legacy dbt models for internal metric tracking using SQL and Jinja templating, optimizing query structure and materialization methods; cut monthly compute costs by 15% and total dbt model runtime by 12%.
- Designed Sigma dashboards for 3 product launches, tracking growth metrics and directly informing decision making. Produced numerous ad hoc reports using Python and SQL for product, sales, and finance teams.
- Developed a Generative Engine Optimization model tracking brand perception in LLM responses.

UCSD DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMICS La Jolla, CA

Research Assistant September 2023 – June 2025

- Built an integrated database combining survey data from 22 Sub-Saharan African countries with historical rainfall and hospital proximity metrics to enable novel health outcomes research.
- Applied econometric models to quantify the causal impact of prenatal care accessibility, finding a 15% reduction in rural infant mortality and improving predictive model accuracy by 40%.
- Designed and implemented a modified Top-Trading Cycles algorithm for student course allocation, modeled algorithm rollout scenarios – results were inconclusive, but methodology could be applied to other fields.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE:

UCSD SUSTAINABLE INVESTMENT GROUP La Jolla, CA

Director of Quantitative Research January 2024 – Present

- Directed a team of 60 in performing, financial instrument & signal development, for medium-term stock forecasts.
- Mentored team members in creating visually compelling stock pitches, resulting in 50+ presentations that showcased innovative investment theses to panels of regional industry professionals in finance.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION:

Technical Skills: R, Python, Swift, SQL, dbt, Snowflake, Sigma, Claude Code, Rive, Agentic AI

Other Activities: Triathlons, Formula 1, DJing House & Techno Music, Reading 1 book a month in 2026